

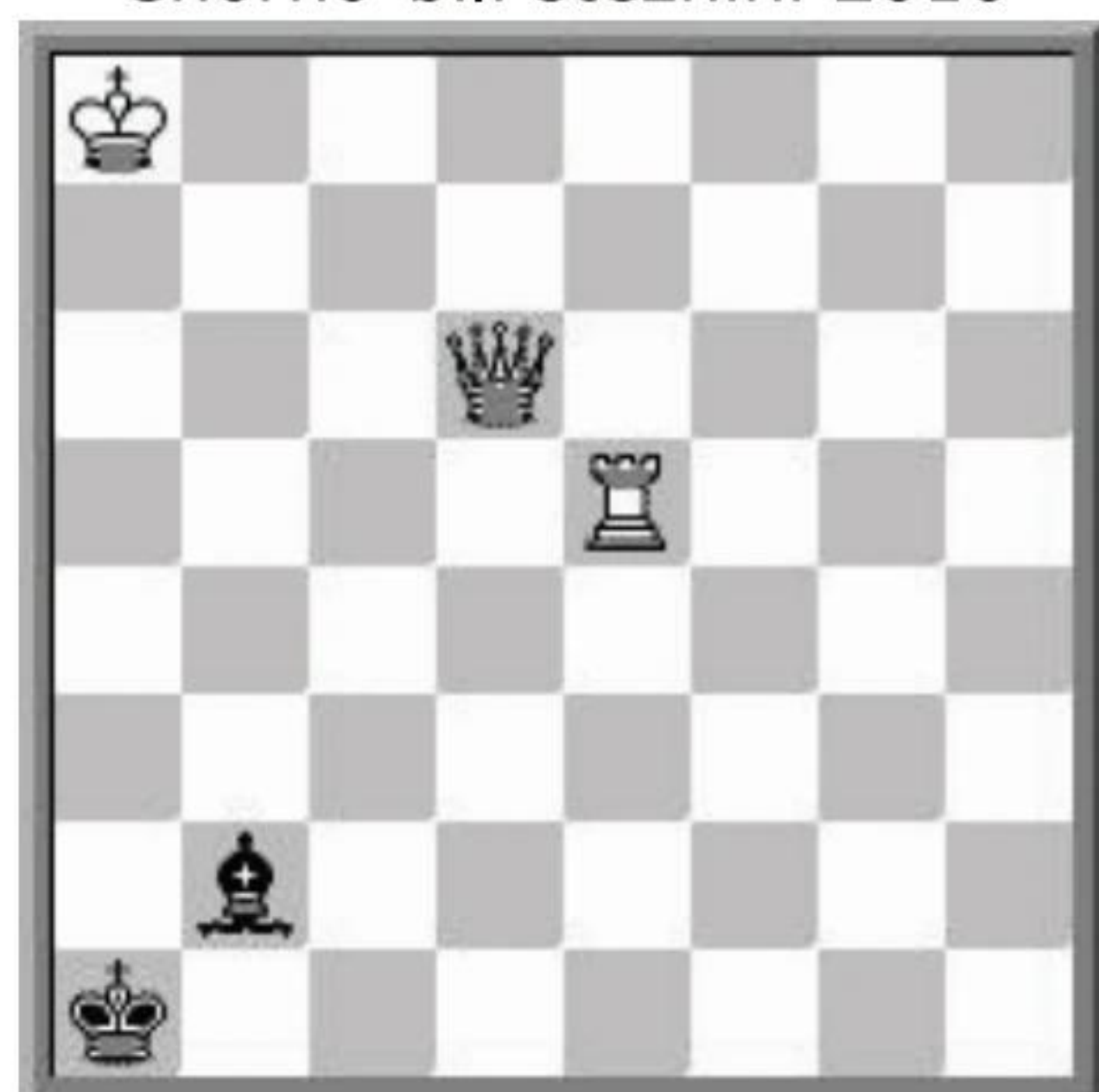
Miniature marvels

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Miniatures, problems with seven or less men, with striking keys were looked at merely as puzzles till the early part of the last century. Themes such as Roman Dresden, Bristol and Holzhausen interferences were some of the later developments in the three movers. Special tournaments exclusively for miniatures have now provided ample opportunity for composers to explore modern themes in the direct mate three-mover. The first one doubles Le Grand theme. WR and WQ interchange the roles in the three tries and key in this aristocratic miniature.

C.Poisson

Sp.Pr,V.Blyukher-120 MT
Chorno-bili stezhini 2010



Mate in three moves

Try: 1. Qd2? A [2. Re2 C [3. Qxb2#] B any 3. Qa2; 1... Ka2 a/ Kb1 2. Rb5 [3. Qxb2#]; 1.. Bc1 b 2. Re1 (3. Rxc1) but 1. ... Bxe5! Try: 1. Qb4? B [2. Rb5 D [3. Qxb2#] 2... Ka2 /Kb1 3. Qxb2#] 1. ... Bc1 b 2. Ra5+ Ba3 3. Rxa3; 1. ... Ka2 a /Kb1 2. Re2 [3. Qxb2#] 2... Kc1 3. Qe1# but 1. ... Bxe5! Try: 1. Re2? C [2. Qd2 A [3. Qxb2#] 2... Ba3 3. Qa2 but 1. ... Bc1!

Key 1.Rb5! D (2.Qb4 B (3.Qxb2) 2... Bc1 3. Qb1#; 1. ... Ka2 a /Kb1 2.

Qd2 [3. Qxb2#] 1. ... Bc1 b 2. Qa6+ Ba3 3. Qxa3# In le Grand theme, the try and the second move threat (indicated by capital letters) get reversed after the king defence and 1...Bc1 (indicated by small alphabets).

A.Melnichuk, First prize,
A.Kozhakin-20 JT Kudesnik 2012

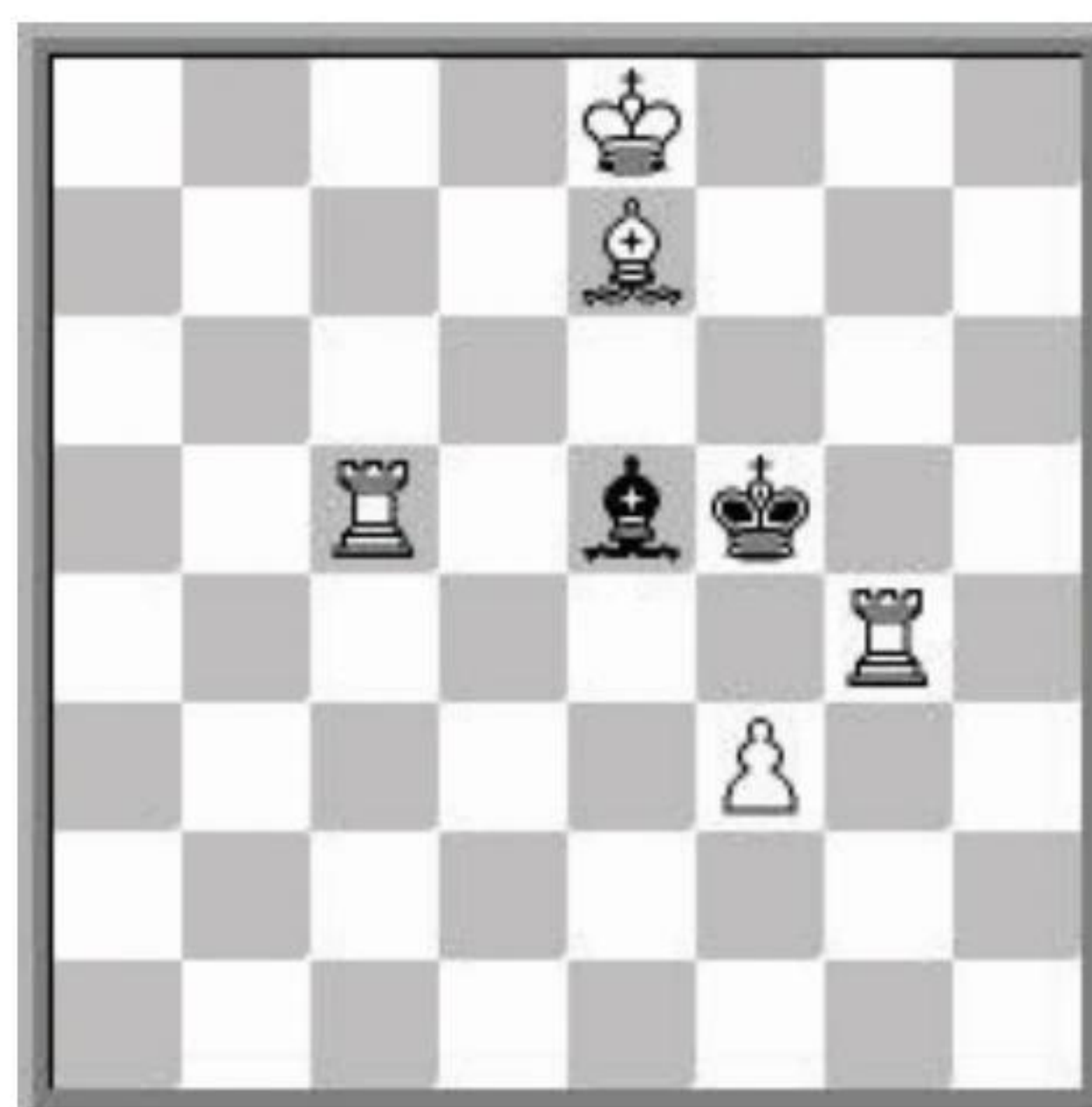


Mate in three moves

Try: 1. Rh6? (2. Rd1+. g1 any 3. Qa8, Rxh2); 1.. g1=Q 2. Qa8+ Qg2 3. Rd1 but 1. ... Kg1! Try: 1. Rh3? [2. Rc1+ g1 any 2. Rxh2/Qa8; 1.. g1=B 2. Rg6 any 3. Qa8 but 1. ... g1=Q! Try: 1. Rd2? [2. Rc1+. g1 any 3. Qxh2, Rxh2]; 1. ... Kg1 2. Qh3 [3. Qxg2#] Kf1 3. Rc1# But 1. ... g1=B! **Key 1. Rc2!** [2. Rd1+]; 1..g1=B 2. Qa8+ Nf3 3. Qxf3; 1...Kg1 2. Qh3 [3. Qxg2#] Kf1 3. Rd1

A miniature zago to solve

J.Roche, 3 Com, Smena 1995



Mate in three moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'The masked Bristol'-**Key**

1.Qg2! threat 2.(Qg4) 1...Rf4 2.Sg3 ; 1...Rg1 2.Qf3; 1...h5 2.Rg5; 1...Rb2 2.Qe4; 1...Rb4 2.Rf7; 1...Rxg7 2.Be4 ; 1...Bg6 2.Qxg6

Readers may send in their queries to
cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com